

Student Guide — senior / module-10-herbs-aushadhi

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Senior)

This workbook is yours to write in. Use it for vocab, exercises, and reflection across all 10 days.

Vocabulary tracker

Fill in as we go:

- *auṣadhi* — _____
- *tulasī* — _____
- *nimba* — _____
- *haridrā* — _____
- *ādraka* — _____
- *yavānī* — _____
- *pudīnā* — _____

Day-by-day notes

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

What I learned:

One question I have:

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Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

What I learned:

One question I have:

Final reflection

After Day 10, write a paragraph: what is the most important thing you learned in this module?

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)

Primary source (today’s reading)

From *Caraka Saṁhitā* — see `sources.md`.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Define *auṣadhi*.** Sanskrit for “medicinal plant” — broader than English “herb.” Includes leaves, roots, barks, seeds, resins. Distinguish from *ahara* (food) and *rasāyana* (rejuvenative).
2. **Six herbs we’ll study.** Show samples: Tulsī, Neem, Turmeric, Ginger, Ajwain, Mint. Pass them around for sight + smell.
3. **The traditional framework.** Each herb has *rasa* (taste), *vīrya* (potency — heating/cooling), *vipāka* (post-digestive effect), and *prabhāva* (specific action). This is the basic *dravyaguṇa* (pharmacology) of Āyurveda.
4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1: “*There is nothing in the world that, applied at the right time and place, is not medicine.*” Read aloud.

5. **The critical caveat, repeated three times.** This module teaches IDENTIFICATION and traditional uses. It does NOT teach therapeutic dosing. Therapeutic use requires a qualified practitioner. State this rule prominently in workbooks.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces What is Auṣadhi?.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *tulasī* (IAST: tulasī; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Ocimum tenuiflorum* (also *O. sanctum*). Square stem, opposite leaves with serrated edges, distinctive aromatic oil glands. Multiple cultivars: *Rama tulasī* (green), *Kṛṣṇa tulasī* (purple), *Vana tulasī* (wild).
2. **Active compound.** Eugenol (60-70% of essential oil), ursolic acid, rosmarinic acid. Some research on adaptogenic / anti-inflammatory effects (Cohen, 2014 — *Journal of Ayurveda and Integrative Medicine*).
3. **Traditional uses.** Caraka and Suśruta cite *tulasī* for: cough, cold, low-grade fever, indigestion (in tea form), as a bedside plant for air quality.
4. **Source.** Atharva Veda 10.97 — Auśadhi Sūkta — though not naming *tulasī* specifically, the framing of “herbs as healing beings” begins here. Caraka *Sūtrasthāna* 26 lists *tulasī* formally.
5. **Smell-test demo.** Crush a leaf; pass around. Note clove-like aroma (eugenol). Modern aroma-chemistry: same compound (eugenol) gives cloves their scent.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Tulsī — Holy Basil.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

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- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. “neem — *Azadirachta indica*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Azadirachta indica*. Tall tree, ~15-20 m. Pinnate compound leaves with serrated leaflets. Distinctive bitter smell when crushed.
2. **Active compound.** Azadirachtin (in seeds, oil). Nimbidin (in leaves, bark). Quercetin (a flavonoid).
3. **Traditional uses.** Caraka and Suśruta cite *nimba* for: skin conditions, fever, infections, oral hygiene (chewing the twig). External use is well-supported by modern studies.
4. **THE SAFETY WARNING.** Neem at high concentrations (especially neem oil) is documented to be hepatotoxic. Caraka itself notes restrictions. Modern pediatric case-reports (e.g. *Indian Pediatrics* journals) document harm in infants given neem oil. NEVER ingest in concentrated form. State this rule THREE TIMES.
5. **Modern use cases.** Neem-based pesticides (azadirachtin is one of the most studied bio-pesticides). Toothpaste with neem extract. Skin creams. Discussion: “*What separates safe external use from risky internal use?*”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see activities/). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Neem — Bitter Healer.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See `lesson-plan.md` for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *haridrā* (IAST: *haridrā*; lit. “turmeric — *Curcuma longa*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Curcuma longa*. A rhizome (underground stem, not a root). Bright orange when cut. Fresh vs dried (turmeric powder).

2. **Active compound.** Curcumin (~2-5% of dried rhizome). Bright yellow polyphenol. Other compounds: turmerones in the essential oil.
3. **Traditional uses.** Caraka cites *haridrā* for: wound healing (topical paste), anti-inflammatory (golden milk), as a colouring + preservative agent in food. Centuries of culinary use.
4. **Modern research.** Curcumin has been studied extensively for anti-inflammatory effects. Bioavailability is poor without piperine (black pepper) or fat — which is why *haldi doodh* (turmeric milk with ghee) is traditional. Modern preparations use liposomal or piperine-enhanced formulations.
5. **Demo / activity.** Crush a small piece of fresh turmeric on paper. Note the staining (curcumin is a pH indicator — colour changes with vinegar/lemon vs baking soda). This is also chemistry, not just culinary.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Turmeric — Golden Root.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *ādraka* (IAST: ādraka; lit. “ginger — *Zingiber officinale*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Zingiber officinale*. Rhizome (like turmeric, not a true root). Light tan skin. Fresh (*ādraka*) vs dried (*śuṇṭhī*) — distinct Sanskrit names because the properties differ.
2. **Active compounds.** Fresh ginger: gingerols. Dried ginger: shogaols (gingerols dehydrate during drying). Both are pungent / “hot.”
3. **Traditional vs modern uses.** Caraka cites ginger for: digestive fire, nausea, cold-induced cough. Modern clinical trials support: nausea (motion sickness, chemo-induced — *Cochrane Reviews*), and mild anti-inflammatory effect.
4. **Two preparations, two effects.** “*Why does Āyurveda distinguish fresh from dried?*” Fresh ginger is heating but mild; dried ginger is more concentrated and warming. Modern: same compound family, different ratios.
5. **Activity.** Smell-test: fresh ginger root vs dried ginger powder. Students rate intensity 1-5 and write one sentence on the difference.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Ginger — Warming Root.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *yavānī* (IAST: *yavānī*; lit. “ajwain — *Trachyspermum ammi*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Trachyspermum ammi*. Small seeds (closer to caraway than parsley). Distinctive sharp aroma. Leaves of the plant resemble parsley.
2. **Active compound.** Thymol (35-60% of essential oil). Same compound as in thyme. Strong antimicrobial and digestive-stimulating actions.
3. **Traditional uses.** Caraka cites *yavānī* primarily for digestive complaints: indigestion, gas, colic. The traditional remedy: a few seeds chewed after a heavy meal.

4. **Modern research.** Thymol’s antimicrobial effect is well-documented in food science (it’s used as a natural preservative). Limited clinical research on traditional digestive claims, but the underlying chemistry is plausible.
5. **Discussion.** “*Why is the same compound (thymol) found in ajwain and thyme — plants from very different families?*” This is *convergent evolution* in plant chemistry: distantly related plants evolving the same defensive compound. A great cross-cultural pharmacology insight.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Ajwain — Carom Seed.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: recognise several mentha varieties; identify menthol.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *pudīnā* (IAST: pudīnā; lit. “mint — *Mentha* spp.”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Mentha* genus — many species: *M. arvensis* (corn mint, *pudīnā*), *M. spicata* (spearmint), *M. piperita* (peppermint). Distinguish by leaf shape, smell.
2. **Active compound.** Menthol (peppermint), carvone (spearmint). Both terpenoids, both “cooling” perceptually (menthol activates cold-sensing TRPM8 receptors in the mouth).
3. **Traditional uses.** Less prominent in classical Caraka/Suśruta (mint was a later introduction to Indian materia medica). Modern Āyurveda uses for: cooling drinks, digestive aid, breath freshener.
4. **Modern research.** Peppermint oil — well-studied for IBS symptom relief (*BMJ*, multiple trials). Cooling sensation is a TRPM8 channel effect, NOT actual cooling of tissue.
5. **Activity.** Cooling-sensation test: students suck on a peppermint and report on tongue temperature. “*Is the mint actually cool? Or does it just feel cool?*” (It’s the TRPM8 receptor activation — the same nerve that signals real cold.)

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Mint — Cooling Leaf.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect (links to module 4).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *auśadhi* (IAST: auśadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Recall doṣa framework (Module 4).** Vāta = motion, Pitta = transformation, Kapha = structure.
2. **Herb classification by doṣa effect.** From Caraka *Sūtrasthāna* 26:
 - **Heating / Pitta-aggravating** (use with care if pitta-dominant): ginger, ajwain, hot pepper.
 - **Cooling / Pitta-pacifying** (good for hot conditions): mint, fennel.
 - **Drying / Kapha-pacifying** (good for congestion): turmeric, neem.
 - **Lubricating / Vāta-pacifying** (good for dryness): ghee-based preparations.
3. **Maps onto modern thermoregulation.** Heating herbs (ginger, ajwain) often increase metabolic rate slightly. Cooling herbs (mint via TRPM8) provide perceptual cooling. The mapping is empirically observed, not purely conceptual.

4. **Worked example.** “If someone has a *vāta* imbalance — dry skin, restless sleep — which of our six herbs would *Āyurveda* recommend?” (Avoid the very dry/cold ones. Ginger in moderate amounts; ghee-based ginger tea.)
5. **Safety reminder.** This is wellness lens, NOT diagnosis. Don’t prescribe based on *doṣa* lens; consult a qualified practitioner.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Herbs and the *Doṣas*.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “What’s one thing you learned today?”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

Module: Herbs — *Auśadhi* · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: each student contributes one identification card to the class library.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *tulasī* (IAST: *tulasī*; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Card-deck project assembly.** Each student claims one of the six herbs as their primary contribution. They produce one detailed identification card:
 - Sanskrit + botanical name
 - Leaf/seed/root drawing (large, accurate)
 - Smell description (concrete words)
 - Three traditional uses with cited sources
 - One active compound and its action
 - One safety note
2. **Tools and references.** Use Caraka Saṁhitā Sūtrasthāna 26 (compiled excerpts in *sources.md*), modern phytochemistry summaries from ICMR-NIN or *Journal of Ethnopharmacology* reviews.
3. **Work-time.** 30 minutes individual work. Teacher circulates to check sources.
4. **Pair-review.** Pairs swap cards; check for accuracy and one quality-improvement suggestion.
5. **Class deck assembly.** Cards laminated (optional) and bound into a class library. Teachers may keep one set for future use.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see *activities/*). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Build the Class Deck.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See *homework.md* for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. “neem — *Azadirachta indica*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Class herb-deck presentation (20 min).** Each student shows their card and gives a 1-minute talk on their herb.
2. **Q&A (10 min).** “*Which herb would you most want in your home garden? Why?*” “*Which one surprised you?*”
3. **Summative quiz (20 min).** Vocabulary, identification, doṣa-pairing, safety. See quizzes/summative.md.
4. **Critical-thinking close.** “*The doṣa-herb framework is ancient. Modern science can test specific claims. Where does each work best? Where does each fall short?*” Each student writes 3 sentences.
5. **Linkage.** Module 13 (Indic Ecology) will revisit this through the *vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam* lens — herbs as part of the larger ecology.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Final Share and Assessment.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

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- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Senior)

Use these for in-class writing, homework, or assessment. Each prompt is suitable for a 300-word response.

1. In 3–4 sentences, explain Herbs — Auṣadhi to a friend who hasn’t taken this module.
2. Choose one Sanskrit term from this module. Define it, then describe one observation from your own life that matches.
3. Compare Herbs — Auṣadhi with a similar concept from another module or from your science textbook. What’s similar? Different?
4. Identify ONE claim in this module that you’d want to test. How would you test it?
5. What was the most surprising thing in this module? Why did it surprise you?
6. Pick one source cited in this module. Write 2 sentences explaining why it matters.
7. What is one common misconception about Herbs — Auṣadhi? Rebut it in 2–3 sentences.
8. Imagine you are teaching this module to a younger student. What would you say first?
9. Read one primary-source passage cited in this module. Translate or paraphrase it; comment on what it adds to your understanding.

10. Identify a contemporary debate about the IKS framework presented here (e.g., is Tirthaji's mathematics genuinely Vedic? are doṣas a valid framework today?). Take a position with two pieces of evidence.

How to use

- Pick **one** prompt per day for the writing-prompts homework.
- Or assign all of them across the module, alternating between in-class and home.
- Senior students may treat any prompt as a 500-word essay topic.

Homework

Homework — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Senior)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 10–15 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
2. **Day 2 — Tulṣī — Holy Basil** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
3. **Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
4. **Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
5. **Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
6. **Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
7. **Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
8. **Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
9. **Day 9 — Build the Class Deck** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
10. **Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.